ROADWISE PH

Vehicle Safety & Checking Knowledge Base

Informative reference for local AI • English and Filipino • Philippines

1. How the AI should use this document

Use this document as general educational guidance. Answer in clear, practical language. If the user asks in Filipino or Taglish, respond in Filipino or Taglish.

Important limitations:

- This is not an official Land Transportation Office (LTO) checklist, legal opinion, mechanical diagnosis, or certificate of roadworthiness.
- Vehicle requirements differ by model, fuel type, transmission, age, and manufacturer. The owner's manual and a qualified mechanic take priority for vehicle-specific maintenance.
- Laws, LTO procedures, and testing requirements can change. Do not invent current rules, fees, deadlines, or legal requirements. If current official requirements are requested and browsing is unavailable, say that the user should confirm with the LTO or an accredited driving school.
- Do not tell a user that a vehicle is safe based only on a text description. If a critical safety defect may be present, recommend stopping in a safe place and arranging professional help.
- Never advise someone to inspect a vehicle in a dangerous position, work beneath a vehicle supported only by a jack, open a hot radiator cap, or touch moving/hot engine components.

2. Pre-trip vehicle inspection

A pre-trip inspection is a brief check before driving to identify obvious safety problems. It should be done while the vehicle is parked safely, ideally on level ground, with the parking brake engaged and the engine off for external checks.

2.1 Tires and wheels

Check each tire for:

- Low pressure, visible cuts, cracks, bulges, exposed cords, embedded objects, or unusual wear.
- A visibly flat or damaged tire.
- Missing or obviously loose wheel nuts.
- A spare tire and basic changing equipment, if supplied with the vehicle.

Use the tire pressure listed on the vehicle's tire-pressure placard or in the owner's manual. Check pressure when tires are cold when practical. Do not use the maximum pressure printed on the tire sidewall as a substitute for the vehicle's recommended pressure.

Filipino: Tingnan kung kulang sa hangin, may hiwa o umbok, may nakalitaw na hibla, o hindi pantay ang pudpod ng gulong. Gamitin ang presyong nakasaad sa sticker ng sasakyan o sa manwal. Huwag bumiyahe kung may gulong na halatang hindi ligtas.

2.2 Lights and visibility

Check:

- Headlamps and tail lamps.
- Brake lamps.
- Left and right turn signals.
- Hazard lights.
- Windshield, windows, and mirrors.
- Wiper blades and washer fluid.
- Horn.
- Camera or parking sensors, if fitted, without relying on them instead of direct observation.

Clean glass, mirrors, lights, and number plates so they are visible. Remove items that obstruct the driver's view.

Filipino: Suriin ang mga ilaw, signal, busina, salamin, windshield, at wiper. Linisin ang mga bahaging nakaaapekto sa paningin. Huwag umasa lamang sa camera o sensor.

2.3 Fluids and visible leaks

When appropriate and following the owner's manual:

- Check engine oil level.
- Check coolant reservoir level only when the engine is cool.
- Check brake-fluid level visually.
- Check washer fluid.
- Look under the vehicle for new or substantial leaks.

Never remove a radiator cap while the engine is hot. Do not drive if there is a major leak, the brake-fluid level is abnormally low, or the vehicle shows signs of overheating. Arrange professional inspection.

Filipino: Suriin ang mga fluid ayon sa manwal. Hintaying lumamig ang makina bago tingnan ang coolant. Huwag buksan ang radiator cap kapag mainit. Ang malaking tagas, mababang brake fluid, o sobrang init ng makina ay dahilan para huminto at magpasuri.

2.4 Brakes, steering, and warning indicators

- Check for an abnormal brake pedal feel or unusual braking noises.
- Check that the parking brake engages and releases normally.
- Observe dashboard warning lights when the ignition is switched on and after the engine starts.
- Pay attention to new steering vibration, unusual looseness, pulling to one side, or abnormal noises.

Do not continue driving if the brakes or steering appear unsafe, or if a critical warning remains on and the owner's manual says immediate attention is required. A warning light can have different meanings by vehicle model.

Filipino: Kung kakaiba ang pakiramdam ng preno, may problema sa manibela, o may kritikal na warning light, huwag ipagpatuloy ang biyahe hangga't hindi nasusuri nang maayos.

2.5 Cabin and occupant safety

Before moving:

- Adjust the seat, head restraint, steering wheel, and mirrors.
- Fasten your seat belt and ask all occupants to buckle up.
- Secure children using a suitable child restraint as required by applicable law.
- Keep pedals clear of bags, bottles, floor mats, and loose objects.
- Close and secure doors, hood, and tailgate.
- Secure cargo so it cannot shift or obstruct visibility.
- Confirm that fuel or battery charge is adequate for the planned trip.

- Carry required vehicle documents and suitable emergency items.

Do not drive while impaired by alcohol, drugs, severe fatigue, or illness. Avoid phone use and other distractions while driving.

Filipino: Ayusin ang upuan at salamin, ikabit ang seat belt, tiyaking ligtas ang mga bata at karga, at alisin ang anumang sagabal sa pedal. Huwag magmaneho kapag nakainom, may epekto ng droga, sobrang pagod, o hindi makapagpokus.

2.6 Basic start-up check

When parked safely:

1. Confirm the parking brake is engaged and the transmission is in the appropriate starting position according to the vehicle manual.

2. Start the vehicle according to the manufacturer's instructions.

3. Listen and look for unusual noise, smoke, burning smells, or warning indicators.

4. Before entering traffic, check the surroundings and test the brake response gently in a safe, clear area.

5. If anything feels unsafe, stop and investigate rather than driving into traffic.

3. When not to drive

Do not begin or continue a trip if any of these conditions make the vehicle unsafe:

- Brake failure or a significant change in braking.
- Steering failure or loss of steering control.
- A visibly damaged, flat, or severely underinflated tire.
- A major fluid leak, overheating, or smoke from the engine area.
- A critical warning that requires immediate attention.
- Visibility too poor to drive safely.
- A door, wheel, or other safety-critical part that is not secure.
- The driver is impaired, dangerously tired, or unable to concentrate.

Move to a safe location if already on the road, use hazard lights when appropriate, keep clear of moving traffic, and contact roadside assistance or a qualified mechanic. Do not stand in a live traffic lane.

Filipino: Huwag bumiyahe kung may sira sa preno o manibela, delikadong gulong, malaking tagas, sobrang init, usok, o hindi sapat ang paningin. Kung nasa kalsada na, tumabi lamang kung ligtas, gumamit ng hazard lights kung angkop, at humingi ng tulong.

4. Practical driving test preparation

This section provides practice guidance only. It is not an official LTO scoring sheet. Requirements and procedures can change, so confirm the latest requirements with the LTO or an accredited driving school.

4.1 Before the test

- Confirm the test appointment and required identification, permits, and documents.
- Confirm with the testing office or driving school which vehicle may be used and what conditions apply.
- Check tires, lights, mirrors, wipers, horn, seat belts, and visible leaks.
- Adjust the seat and mirrors and fasten the seat belt.
- Learn the controls: indicators, headlights, hazard lights, wipers, parking brake, and gear selector.

4.2 Safe driving habits to practise

- Observe surroundings before moving.

- Check mirrors and blind spots before turning, reversing, or changing lanes.
- Signal early enough before turning or changing lanes.
- Obey traffic lights, signs, road markings, and lawful directions.
- Stop correctly at stop lines and where required.
- Yield to pedestrians and other road users when required.
- Maintain a safe following distance and an appropriate speed for conditions.
- Choose the correct lane and avoid abrupt or unsafe maneuvers.
- Reverse and park slowly, observing all sides and stopping if uncertain.
- Keep control of the vehicle and avoid distractions.
- Finish by stopping in a safe location and securing the vehicle.

Filipino: Magsanay sa maayos na pag-andar at pagpreno, tamang pag-signal, pagtingin sa blind spot, pagsunod sa road signs, pagbibigay-daan sa pedestrian, ligtas na paglipat ng lane, pag-atras, at pag-park. Sundin ang tagubilin ng instructor o examiner basta naaayon sa batas at kaligtasan.

4.3 Practice feedback

After practice, record:

- Date and vehicle used.
- Skills performed confidently.
- Skills that need improvement.
- Instructor feedback.
- Next practice date.

Focus on safe, consistent habits rather than memorizing a presumed test route or trying to exploit scoring shortcuts.

5. Vehicle maintenance

Maintenance intervals depend on the vehicle model, mileage, age, operating conditions, and manufacturer's schedule. Use the owner's manual and have safety-critical work done by a qualified mechanic.

5.1 Maintenance items

- Engine oil and oil filter: check level and change according to the schedule.
- Cooling system: check coolant as instructed and have leaks investigated.
- Brakes: inspect pads/shoes, discs/drums, fluid, and parking brake.
- Tires: check pressure, tread, damage, alignment, rotation, and spare tire.
- Battery: inspect condition and terminals safely; have charging issues checked.
- Belts and hoses: check for cracks, wear, swelling, or leaks.
- Air filter: inspect and replace according to the schedule.
- Lights, indicators, horn, wipers, and washer system: check regularly.
- Transmission and other fluids: check only as specified by the manual.
- Steering and suspension: seek inspection for looseness, unusual noises, vibration, or uneven tire wear.
- Exhaust: seek inspection for damage, leaks, or unusual smoke.
- Seat belts and child restraints: inspect for damage and follow applicable recall guidance.
- Documents: keep registration and required documents current according to applicable rules.
- Cleaning: keep windows, mirrors, lights, and plates clean and visible.

- Records: note service date, odometer reading, work performed, parts replaced, and next due service.

5.2 Signs that need professional attention

Arrange a qualified inspection if you notice:

- New or worsening noises.
- Vibration or shaking.
- Vehicle pulling to one side.
- Burning smells or unusual smoke.
- Fluid leaks.
- Changes in braking or steering.
- Repeated warning lights.
- Uneven tire wear.
- Overheating or repeated battery/starting problems.

Do not diagnose a complex mechanical failure from a symptom alone. Different faults can produce similar symptoms.

Filipino: Sundin ang maintenance schedule ng manufacturer. Ipasuri agad ang bagong ingay, panginginig, paghila sa isang panig, amoy sunog, usok, tagas, warning light, o pagbabago sa preno at manibela. Huwag magpalagay ng tiyak na sira nang walang pagsusuri.

6. Emergency and Philippine road-condition safety

6.1 Breakdown

- If possible, move out of traffic to a safe location.
- Turn on hazard lights when appropriate.
- Keep occupants away from moving traffic and choose a safe place to wait.
- Contact roadside assistance or emergency services as appropriate.
- Do not attempt repairs in a live lane or beneath a vehicle supported only by a jack.
- Use warning devices only when safe and lawful.

6.2 Heavy rain and flooding

- Reduce speed and increase following distance in rain.
- Expect reduced visibility, slippery surfaces, and longer stopping distances.
- Do not enter floodwater if its depth, current, or road condition is uncertain.
- Floodwater can conceal potholes, open drains, debris, or road damage.
- If water is rising around a vehicle, prioritize personal safety and follow local emergency guidance; do not risk entering moving floodwater.

Filipino: Sa malakas na ulan, magbagal at dagdagan ang distansya. Huwag pumasok sa baha kung hindi alam ang lalim, agos, o kondisyon ng kalsada. Maaaring may nakatagong butas, kanal, o debris sa ilalim ng tubig.

6.3 Heat and long trips

- Plan rest breaks and do not drive when dangerously tired.
- Check coolant and tires before a long trip, following the manual.
- Bring water and a charged phone.

- If the engine overheats, stop in a safe place and follow the owner's manual. Never open a hot cooling-system cap.

6.4 Emergency readiness

Consider carrying equipment appropriate to the vehicle and trip, such as a first-aid kit, charged phone, flashlight, and manufacturer-provided emergency tools. Check current local rules and the vehicle manual for required or recommended equipment. Do not assume every item is legally required for every vehicle.

7. Common questions and safe answers

Q: Can I drive if the check-engine light is on? A: The meaning depends on the vehicle and warning behavior. Consult the owner's manual. If the light flashes, the engine runs abnormally, the vehicle overheats, or there is smoke or a burning smell, stop safely and arrange professional help. Do not assume it is safe based on the light alone.

Q: Can I open the radiator cap to check coolant? A: Never open a hot radiator cap. Pressurized hot coolant can cause severe burns. Follow the owner's manual and wait until the system is cool.

Q: What tire pressure should I use? A: Use the vehicle's tire-pressure placard or owner's manual. The correct value can differ by vehicle and load. Do not guess a universal pressure.

Q: Is this an official LTO checklist? A: No. This is a general educational guide. Confirm current test procedures and requirements with the LTO or an accredited driving school.

Q: Does passing this checklist prove the vehicle is roadworthy? A: No. A visual checklist cannot detect every mechanical defect. A qualified inspection may be necessary.

Q: Can I drive through floodwater if the water looks shallow? A: Do not enter if depth, current, or road condition is uncertain. Water can hide hazards and rise quickly.

Q: My brakes feel soft or behave differently. Can I continue? A: Do not continue driving when braking may be unsafe. Stop in a safe place and arrange professional assistance.

Q: What maintenance schedule should I follow? A: Follow the schedule in the owner's manual for the exact vehicle. Conditions such as heavy traffic, dust, frequent short trips, or severe weather may affect service needs.

8. Guidance for RoadWise PH AI responses

When answering:

1. Start with the direct answer.

2. Give practical steps in a clear order.

3. Include a brief Filipino explanation if useful.

4. Separate general education from official legal requirements.

5. Never invent LTO rules, exact penalties, service intervals, or vehicle specifications.

6. Ask for the vehicle make, model, year, and symptoms when those details materially affect the answer.

7. For brake, steering, tire, overheating, fuel leak, smoke, or other potentially dangerous problems, prioritize safety and professional inspection.

8. If a question needs current legal or official information, direct the user to verify with the LTO or another relevant official source.

9. Do not claim to have inspected a vehicle, verified a license, or confirmed legal compliance.

10. Do not use the user's assumed city or current address. This guide is intended for general Philippine use.

9. Glossary

- **Pre-trip inspection:** A brief safety check before driving. / Pagsusuri bago bumiyahe.
- **Tread:** The patterned surface of a tire that contacts the road. / Bahaging may ukit ng gulong na dumidikit sa kalsada.
- **Blind spot:** An area not easily visible in mirrors. / Bahaging hindi madaling makita sa salamin.

- **Brake fluid:** Hydraulic fluid used by the braking system. / Fluid na ginagamit ng hydraulic brake system.
- **Coolant:** Fluid that helps control engine temperature. / Fluid na tumutulong kontrolin ang init ng makina.
- **Warning light:** Dashboard indicator that signals a system condition or fault. / Ilaw sa dashboard na nagpapahiwatig ng kondisyon o problema.
- **Roadworthy:** In a condition suitable for safe road use; a checklist alone cannot certify this. / Nasa kondisyong angkop sa ligtas na paggamit sa kalsada; hindi ito mapapatunayan ng checklist lamang.
- **Odometer:** Instrument that records distance traveled. / Panukat ng kabuuang distansyang tinakbo.
- **Owner's manual:** Manufacturer's instructions for operating and maintaining the vehicle. / Manwal ng manufacturer para sa paggamit at maintenance.

10. Disclaimer

This knowledge base is for general road-safety education. It is not a substitute for current Philippine law, official LTO guidance, the vehicle manufacturer's instructions, professional driving instruction, emergency services, or inspection by a qualified mechanic. Verify changing requirements with the appropriate official source.